

Regular Meeting
June 20, 2016
School Committee Meeting
Council Chambers

The regular meeting of the Medford School Committee was called to order by Mayor Burke in the City Hall Council Chambers at 7:05 p.m. Those present were Ms.Cugno, Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Kreatz, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Skerry, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mayor Burke and Superintendent Belson.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry that the minutes of June 6, 2016 be approved:

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

On the motion of Mr. Skerry that the Bills/Transfer of Funds be approved:

Voted: That the Bills/Transfer of Funds be approved.

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke
Nay: 0
Absent: 0

On the motion of Mr. Skerry that the Payrolls be approved:

Voted: That the Payrolls be approved.

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke
Nay: 0
Absent: 0

Committee of the Whole – Superintendent’s Evaluation SY 2015 –2016

Mayor Burke highlighted the minutes. Mayor Burke stated that the purpose of the meeting was to conduct the annual Evaluation of the Superintendent of Schools.

The committee members each took a turn evaluating the Superintendent. Each provided ratings for the four standards. The overall rating for all standards is 3.87 (High Proficient)

On the motion of Mr. Skerry to accept the report and place on file:

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

Report on Administrative Work Week

Deputy Superintendent Beverly Nelson presented the report. Ms. Nelson stated that each year after school has ended administrators gather for five days of meetings. During this time they debrief on the past year and plan for the upcoming year. This schedule also provides time to meet individually with administrators to address their specific needs. This year our administrative meetings will be held June 22-28. We find that these end of year meetings with all administrative staff provide time for quality collaboration. Administrators have the opportunity to share experiences and best practices. Administrators officially return to work on August 22, a week before school begins for students. Our meetings will continue throughout the week of August 22-26 so that everything is in place for the opening of school.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry to accept the report and place on file:

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

Report on Merger of the GBL with Northeast Athletic Conference

Superintendent Belson said that the merger between the GBL and the Northeast Conference will go into effect next spring. The GBL will be meeting with the NEC in the fall to finalize all of the details going forward. The Medford/Malden Thanksgiving Day football game will not be impacted. Congratulations go out to Coach Dempsey who was named Boston Globe Coach of the Year and also Ashley Eisnor named to the Boston Globe's and Boston Herald's All Scholastic Girls Softball Teams. Also congratulations go out to our girls softball, girls tennis, girls lacrosse and boys lacrosse all GBL champs.

Discussion:

Ms. Van der Kloot commented that she had no idea that this was happening. She asked if this needs the a school committee vote. Superintendent Belson replied that although it is not needed he would like the school committee's endorsement. Ms. Van der Kloot asked if there are any other options. Superintendent Belson answered that they have been looking for years to do something. Ms. Van der Kloot asked if any sports will be affected or any changes made. Athletic Director Maloney answered that as of today everything will remain the same. They will meet again in September. It is planned to be sixteen teams with a North and a South division. Ms. Cugno asked if this travel would impact the budget. Mr. Maloney said they will try to be creative and possibly schedule double headers during weekends and/or vacation weeks.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry to approve the merger with the Northeast Conference:

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke
Nay: 0
Absent: 0

Recommendation to Approve Community Schools Fee Structure

Superintendent Belson asked Director of Finance and Administration to go over the details of the fee structure. Ms. Velie began by stating that the accommodation has been made to ensure the City of Medford and Medford Public Schools entities have been

addressed. In conjunction of the fee schedule the community schools department will be implementing R school software which will provide venue calendars, invoicing, receipt tracking, team rosters, reporting and much more. She highlighted the following: groups grandfathered in include: Medford Youth Soccer and Medford Youth Lacrosse. Rates for these users: \$75/hr.practice on Edgerly Field and \$100/hr for games. Rental space is based on availability. Medford Community Based non-profit groups may apply to rent facilities for \$75/hr if a custodian, tech assistance, etc. is on duty. If custodial, tech assistance, etc are required to be hired, the posted fees for such services apply. A letter of non-profit status is required at time of rental. Registered MPS Booster organizations will be allowed available times (times not otherwise booked) at the gym and Edgerly Field; it is expected that these MPS Booster organizations provided significant MPS team support. This free-of charge time assumes no special costs i.e. custodial, tech assistance, etc. If such are required to be hired, the posted fees apply. All Booster groups will be required to register with Community Schools. Community Subsidy to underwrite City of Medford non-profit groups requesting theater use outside of regular school hours, MPS will ask for a subsidy for user discount. School Committee will be asked to approve each request at the next regularly scheduled meeting. Continuous Large Block Use to be negotiated between the Superintendent and User Group with a written contract with payment schedule, to include youth sports' seasonal rental rates. Should the City of Medford revise the rental rates for Hormel Stadium a discussion should also ensue related to Edgerly Field rental rates; therefore, providing enough notice for current renters.

Discussion:

Ms. DiBenedetto asked with these fees are we going to raise enough money to pay bills etc. Ms. Velie answered that the new tracking system will help this. Ms. DiBenedetto stressed that the groups that are grandfathered need to file a copy of their 5013c with the office. She also requested that Booster clubs are non profit also or show that they have filed to become non profit. She also requested that the name and contact information be included on all contracts for each organization. Ms. Cugno asked Mr. Maloney who is in charge when he is not there. Mr. Maloney said that there is always someone overseeing rentals. Ms. Cugno requested that coaches provide schedules and contact information to both students and parents. Ms. DiBenedetto suggested including all sports camps in the Medford Recreation booklet.

On the motion to approve the fee schedule with amendments of adding non profit to Booster Club and including point of contact information:

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke
Nay: 0
Absent: 0

Report on Proposed Succession Plan for Superintendent

Superintendent Belson stated pursuant to a vote by the Medford School Committee the following "Succession Plan" has been developed for a vacancy in the position of Superintendent of Schools. There are two main scenarios addressed by this document. The first responds to an untimely, unexpected vacancy and the second deals with a planned vacancy:

1. Untimely/Unexpected Vacancy: If the Superintendent is unable to perform his duties for any reason, the Deputy Superintendent would become the Interim

Superintendent. The School Committee would begin a search process for a permanent replacement. The Deputy would serve until either the Superintendent returned or a new leader was selected. The current school system administration is an experienced team that can handle transition and maintain operations for an extended period of time. We have an Assistant Superintendent, Director of Finance and Administration, Director of Pupil Services, Director of Buildings and Grounds as well as Principals/Assistant Principals and Departmental Directors in place. Each would be able to carry out their essential functions.

2. Announced Vacancy: The Medford School Committee could retain the Massachusetts Association of School Committees (MASC) or a similar organization for a reasonable fee. A comprehensive search process normally takes four to five months to complete. The time frame may vary depending upon the geographical boundaries of the search and the number of community focus groups and site visits. The typical search process has five phases. They are as follows:

Phase I Leadership Profile Development - 1 month

Phase II Candidate Recruitment – 1 month

Phase III Candidate Screening – 1 month

Phase IV Committee Evaluation of Candidate/Finalists – 3 weeks

Phase V Appointment and Contract Negotiations – 3 weeks

The process of community involvement can take many forms including: community survey online, community forum, categorical focus groups and/or service on a candidate screening team. The selection of an organization such as MASC can greatly facilitate the selecting process. Their experience and contacts will enhance the possibilities of finding a good fit for Medford. Lastly, there will be a transition process between the outgoing leadership and the incoming Superintendent. Every effort will be made by my administration to assist in this process. The above report and attached information should help allay concerns that a succession plan is in place and a process can happen in a reasonable time frame.

Discussion:

Ms. Cugno stressed the importance of using either MASC or another organization to facilitate the search. Ms. Van der Kloot thanked the Superintendent for the report. Ms. DiBenedetto thanked him also saying this is a good basis and starting point. There is more work to do and she suggested continuing the discussion at the start of the school year perhaps attending a workshop by MASC on selecting a Superintendent. Ms. Cugno said that perhaps at a Committee of the Whole the Executive Director of MASC could be invited to speak to them.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto to set up a meeting of the personnel sub committee for the end of September:

Vote:

Yes: 7

No: 0

Absent: 0

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto to send paper to the sub committee:

Vote:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

On the motion of Mr. Skerry to suspend the rules to take papers out of order:

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

Recognition of Medford Kiwanis for Annual Elementary Book Donation

Mayor Burke said that the Medford Public Schools would once again like to thank the Kiwanis Club of Medford for their generous donation of books to our first and third grade students. The Kiwanis Club has always gone above and beyond for the children of Medford. The students are overjoyed when they receive their books. This is such a great way to kick off the summer.

Rick Caraviello represented the Kiwanis Club and distributed book bags to the members of the school committee.

On the motion of Mr. Skerry the report was accepted and placed on file.

Yes: 7
No: 0
Absent: 0

Recommendation to Approve Summer Rules

Superintendent Belson stated that from June 21, 2016, through our first meeting in September, 2016, I am requesting that the School Committee grant authority to the Superintendent and the School Committee Secretary for the following:

1. That the authority shall be granted to the Secretary of the School Committee to approve bills and payrolls during July and August, and that the School Committee be kept informed of the bills and payrolls approved.
2. That the Administration be given permission to open bids, in order to proceed on repair and maintenance work and other essential procurements. Notice to the School Committee will be provided.
3. That the Superintendent be authorized to conduct the normal and necessary business of the school district throughout the summer.
4. That the Superintendent keep the School Committee apprised of any special situations or circumstances during the summer months or that are projected to occur at the opening of schools in September.
5. That the Superintendent supply the School Committee with a summer update report by August 1st.

Discussion:

Ms. Vander der Kloot requested that the Superintendent add #5 – supply the School Committee with a summer report by August 1st. Ms. DiBenedetto said that she would like a meeting in the summer before school starts. Mayor Burke said if necessary it will be scheduled. Ms. DiBenedetto reaffirmed that parents can come to them with any concerns. Superintendent Belson said that if three members want to call a meeting then it will be scheduled at an agreeable time. Ms. Van der Klott said that the mid August memo

from the Superintendent is very informative. Ms. Cugno said that just because we don't meet the Superintendent keeps us informed.

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot to approve the summer rules as amended:

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke

Nay: 0

Absent: 0

New Business:

School Committee Resolution

Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee express its sincere condolences to the victims' families of the tragic Orlando Terrorism.

School Committee Resolution

Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee express its sincere condolences to the family of Robert Surabian. Mr. Surabian was a prominent local businessman whose family operated Cradock Apothecary. Mr. Surabian was also the President of Medford Cooperative Bank and a strong supporter of public education.

A moment of silence was held.

Appointment of Principal for Brooks Elementary School

Superintendent Belson reported that pursuant to my consultation with the Brooks faculty/staff and the leadership of the Brooks parent groups as well as my consultation with the School Committee at our last meeting, I am announcing that Ms. Suzanne Galusi will be the next Principal of the Brooks School. Ms. Galusi is fully licensed by the Department of Elementary and Secondary Education of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts to be an Elementary Principal. She has a BA from Framingham State and a MEd from Lesley University. Ms. Galusi has fourteen excellent years experience as an elementary school teacher and four very successful years as the Assistant Principal of the Brooks School. Her appointment will be effective July 1, 2016. During the upcoming administrators week Ms. Galusi will meet with the Superintendent and the Central Office Team to begin a process of identifying an Assistant Principal.

Discussion:

Suzanne Galusi thanked Superintendent Belson and the School Committee for the opportunity. She said it has come full circle since she was a student at the Brooks many years ago and is now the Principal. Members congratulated Ms. Galusi and wished her the best in her new endeavor.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto the report was accepted and placed on file.

Yes: 7

No: 0

Absent: 0

Public Hearing School Budget FY 2017

The public hearing began at 8:10 p.m. Superintendent Belson began by saying that pursuant to our budget deliberations on Wednesday, June 15, 2016, I have made the following modifications to our FY 2017 budget. All proposed modifications are subject to your approval. Please note the following:

1. Math Coach at elementary level will be added and funded under Title I. The salary will be determined based upon the teachers' contract and the individual's credentials.
2. Middle School Librarian will be added to BLK 029. The salary will be based upon the teachers' contract B-1(\$48,863). The position will be shared between the two schools. The position will eliminate one .5 para position at \$11,690. The differential will be \$37,173 and will be funded through combined savings generated by leaves of absence granted in the vocational and science departments.
3. Behavior Specialist for the Columbus School is added by promoting a current paraprofessional in the Sped budget who has recently earned the credentials to fulfill this role. This is a non unit position. The salary will be \$40,000 and will be offset by the para's current salary of \$21,639 and the projected savings from the mid year retirement of a senior sped teacher. The senior sped teacher will be replaced at a lower salary consistent with the teachers' contract.
4. Three part time Kindergarten Aides will be full time at the Roberts. Each will move from their current salary of \$7,925 to \$15,850. The total increase will be \$23,775. Funding for these positions will be taken from the revenue projection which is listed in the budget book. Assignments will be based upon the contract provisions of the paraprofessional contract.
5. The Teacher Specialist position at the McGlynn Elementary will be absorbed by existing personnel at that school. Principal Guarino reviewed the situation and made the decision. Please see her attached letter. While the possibility existed for an internal shift of personnel, the Principal opted to use existing faculty.
6. Clerical assignments will be reviewed during the administrative week and decisions will be made regarding the realignment of personnel. Key positions will be covered.

The Superintendent also mentioned the memo that was distributed to the committee regarding the sale of the musical instruments. The memo reads that the funds raised through the sale of the older musical instruments be deposited back to the school department through the Gifts (115) account to be spent on new musical equipment as determined by the Fine Arts Department. We continue to watch the state budget deliberations. However, it is unlikely that a final reconciliation will occur before our budget is finalized. We will keep you informed and any major changes will be brought to the School Committee for approval.

Discussion:

Ms. Van der Kloot commented that she thought that the monies should be at the music departments discretion not specifically equipment.

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot to change the language to "use by music department"

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke
Nay: 0

Absent: 0

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot that the surplus funds be deposited into a gift account:

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke

Nay: 0

Ms. Van der Kloot continued stating that the Superintendent has met our concerns. Ms. DiBenedetto had many questions for the Superintendent. She began by asking what the credentials are for a Behaviorist? Ms. Medaglio answered that they are highly trained in analyzing sped students but they have not received their test results. Ms. DiBenedetto went over the list of additions and deletions to the budget. She stated that she still wants more especially the Literacy Coach at the McGlynn and kindergarten aides in all schools. This is a must for next year. She is not in favor of retaining the position of Public Information Officer. She feels that these funds could be spent better elsewhere. Ms. Kreatz interjected that we need to continue to get the news out to the public and this is an important position. She is in support of retaining it. Ms. Mustone asked if there is a cap on the number of students that can be in a class with a para. Superintendent Belson answered that it is in the teachers contract but it is in the 20's and in sped classes it depends of they type of class. Ms. DiBenedetto asked for a breakdown of the TRITEC grant.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto that all experanious accounts be included in the budget book next year:

Yes: 7

No: 0

Absent: 0

The Public Hearing was opened for public discussion at 9:00 p.m..

Maria Skiffington, Roberts teacher, thanked the committee and the Superintendent for the full time kindergarten aides.

Public Hearing ended at 9:04 p.m.

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. Cugno to approve the Medford Public Schools budget:

Yes: 5 Cugno, Kreatz, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke

No: 2 DiBenedetto, Mustone

Ms. Van der Kloot asked the two no votes to reconsider stating that unity is needed. Ms. Cugno said that the principals were asked what they want and they were given that. It is embarrassing to go to the Council with a 5-2 vote. Ms. Mustone stated the reason for her no vote is that during her campaign she said that the Kindergarten Aides in all schools were her priority. Ms. DiBenedetto commented that she raised concerns during the entire budget and she voted as she feels best.

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot seconded by Ms. Cugno to go the Executive Session at 9:18 p.m. for the discussion of Negotiations and Legal Matters pertaining to Vocational Director, Superintendent's Contract, Non Unit Personnel, Carpenters/Maintenance Unit and budget related negotiations.

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke

Nay: 0

The School Committee returned from Executive Session at 10:30 p.m. and took the following votes:

On the motion of Ms. Cugno, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot:

Non Unit Personnel (see attached listing)

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke

Nay: 0

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. Cugno:

Superintendent of Schools – 1 year contract extension (June 2018) terms to be negotiated.

Roll Call:

Yes: 5 Cugno, Kreatz, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke

No: 2 DiBenedetto, Mustone

On the motion of Ms. Cugno, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot:

Headmaster Dr. John Perella FY 17 4% FY 18 3%

Roll Call:

Yes: 5 Cugno, Kreatz, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke

No: 2 DiBenedetto, Mustone

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. Cugno:

Principal Dr. Heidi Riccio FY 17 8% FY 18 3%

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke

Nay: 0

On the motion of Mr. Skerry, seconded by Ms. Cugno the meeting was adjourned at 10:36 p.m.

Roll Call:

Yea: 7 Cugno, DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Skerry, Van der Kloot, Burke

Nay: 0

Absent: 0

Respectfully submitted:

Robert E. Skerry Jr.
Secretary

